

NORTH EAST REGIONAL HEALTH AUTHORITY DATA QUALITY AUDIT REPORT 2026

Strategic Information Component
MINISTRY OF HEALTH AND WELLNESS
Submitted June 29, 2026

Executive Summary

The 2026 HIV Prevention Data Quality Audit (DQA) for the North East Regional Health Authority (NERHA) assessed the quality, completeness, and reliability of prevention data reported in the District Health Information System 2 (DHIS2) against source outreach registers. The audit reviewed eleven (11) core indicators related to client demographics, outreach activities, HIV and syphilis testing, and HIV self-test distribution. A total of 2,548 entries from January–September 2025 were selected for audit, of which 2,193 (86%) were presented for verification, representing a decrease from 93% in 2025.

The audit found substantial improvements in the accuracy of several key indicators. Matching rates for syphilis and HIV showed an increase from 90% in 2025 to 97% in 2026, while targeted population identified increase from 93% to 97%. The accuracy for year of birth and sex both increased from 94% in 2025 to 99% in 2026. Month of birth increased from 93% to 99%, Day of birth from 92% to 98% and Outreach officer's name increase from 95% to 99%. Last name increased from 91% in 2025 to 98% in 2026. These findings demonstrate strengthened data capture practices and greater consistency in recording critical client-level information, which enhances the reliability of programme monitoring and reporting.

Despite these gains, the audit identified significant weaknesses that affected overall performance. The proportion of outreach register entries fully aligned with DHIS2 decreased 88% in 2025 to 71% in 2026, while overall data accuracy decreased from 88% to 83%. These findings point to persistent challenges in data entry, reconciliation, and the timely upload of outreach records into DHIS2. Across all parishes, the audits identified outreach and HIV self-test records that were documented in source registers but had not been entered into the electronic reporting system, resulting in discrepancies between reported and actual service delivery data.

The implications of these findings are significant. Incomplete or unmatched records compromise the integrity of programme data, potentially leading to underreporting of services delivered, inaccurate assessment of programme performance, and suboptimal resource allocation. Reduced confidence in reported data may also limit the programme's ability to accurately monitor coverage, identify service gaps, and demonstrate progress toward national HIV prevention targets. Furthermore, discrepancies between source documents and DHIS2 increase the risk of inaccurate strategic and operational decision-making.

While data management and storage practices were strong, achieving a regional score of 100%, operational challenges remained evident such as supervisory staffing at regional and parish level and reliable internet connectivity. These factors contributed to delays in data entry, incomplete uploads, and reduced audit performance.

Overall, NERHA received a DQA compliance score of 71%, resulting in a “Needs Improvement” rating. Parish-level scores ranged from 80% in Portland to 64% in St. Ann, indicating that data quality challenges are region-wide rather than isolated (See table 1). Although improvements in indicator-level accuracy demonstrates that there is progress in data collection practices, the decline in data completeness, register-to-DHIS2 alignment, and overall audit scores highlights the need for strengthened data reconciliation processes, routine quality assurance activities, enhanced staff

capacity, and timely entry of all outreach records into DHIS2. Addressing these issues will be critical to ensuring that prevention programme data accurately reflect service delivery and can effectively support evidence-based planning, monitoring, and decision-making.

Table 1: Data Quality Compliance Rating 2026

Parish	DQA Score	Compliance Rating
Portland	80%	Needs Improvement
St. Ann	64%	Needs Improvement
St. Mary	69%	Needs Improvement
NERHA	71%	Needs Improvement